👩‍🏫 Staff Guide · US History · Unit 3 Angel Island reading

New pieces for Levels 1, 2 and 3. L1 = about 2nd-grade reading with emoji and pictures. L2 = about 3rd-grade reading. L3 = close to the class work (guided notes and readings, no slide decks). Every lesson opens with the 5-minute review in the class plan.

1. What each piece goes with

Class lesson / piece	Our files	Notes
Voices of Angel Island reading + questions	L1/L2/L3 reading + check questions + keys + read-aloud pages	Fills our 🚧 item “Angel Island reading.” Written by our team from general historical facts. The class reading's oral-history excerpts are NOT copied, so the class questions about the three people in it need the class reading.

2. Supports built in

- L1: read aloud; picture choices; pointing counts.
- L2: word banks; 3 choices; no 'all of the above.'
- L3: class questions with short answers; no slide decks.
- Talk about the Chinese Exclusion Act as an unfair law; keep the focus on the immigrants' experience.

3. What to grade

- Check questions: 1 point each.
- These are modifications. Modified grading only as the IEP allows. Check with the case manager.

4. Who to ask

- The SLE teacher: changes and IEP questions.
- Facts we could not confirm say “check with the class teacher”.

Picture credits

Detention center at U.S. Immigration Station Angel Island.jpg · E bailey · CC BY-SA 4.0 · Wikimedia Commons

👩‍🏫 Staff Guide · US History · Unit 3 Immigration & Cities (Level 3)

Level 3 = resource-room students who can work close to the gen ed lesson. No slide decks: students follow Ms. Stockmar's lesson and slides with Level 3 readings, guided notes and a quick check.

1. How the pieces line up

Gen ed lesson	Level 3 piece
Her readings and worksheets	Level 3 reading (5 short paragraphs) + check questions
Class notes	Level 3 guided notes + key
Unit quiz / test	Level 3 quick check + key
Review (Kahoot / Jeopardy)	1 Level 3 game on the class site: 10 questions + a matching round

2. Supports built in

- 🔊 Read aloud on the reading and notes pages (tap the button)
- Key terms listed at the top of the notes
- Short-answer lines sized for 1-2 sentences

3. What to grade

- Notes and reading checks: same points as her worksheets for that lesson
- Quick check: score, then scale to her test points
- Modified grading only as the IEP allows. Check with the case manager.

4. Who to ask

- Mr. Driver (SLE): changes and IEP questions.
- Facts we could not confirm say “check with Ms. Stockmar”.

🚧 Under construction (check with Ms. Stockmar)

- **Unit placement**: Her 2026 calendar goes Heartland → Imperialism → WWI. Immigration & Cities (Unit 3), Progressives (Unit 4) and Civil Rights 1900 (Unit 5) come from her earlier-year calendars. Check whether she teaches them this year.
- **Angel Island reading**: The “Voices from Angel Island” primary-source reading is not in the export (only the answer frame). Our notes follow her question frame.

💗 Sensitive topic note

Her immigration cartoons (Chinese immigrant cartoons, “Noah's Ark”) include racist caricatures of Chinese and other immigrants. We do not show them; we describe the message. If the class views them, name the stereotype first and focus on what the cartoon shows about attitudes at the time. Some students may be immigrants or have family who are; keep push/pull talk general and never ask students to share their status.

🗽 Immigration & Cities: Guided Notes

US History · Unit 3 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with push/pull notes, Ellis Island, Voices of Angel Island, How the Other Half Lives

Name: _____

Use the class slides and your reading. Key words:

immigrant | *push factor* | *pull factor* | *Ellis Island* | *Angel Island* | *Chinese Exclusion Act* | *tenement* | *Jacob Riis* | *melting pot* | *nativism*

A. Why they came (push/pull notes)

1. Fill in the table.

	Examples
Push factors	
Pull factors	

2. Fear of or dislike for immigrants is called _____.

B. Arrival (Ellis Island and Angel Island)

3. Fill in the table.

	Ellis Island	Angel Island
Where?		
Mostly from?		
What happened?		

4. What hardships did Fong See and the Angel Island immigrants face?

C. Cities (How the Other Half Lives)

5. Describe tenement conditions. Give three details.

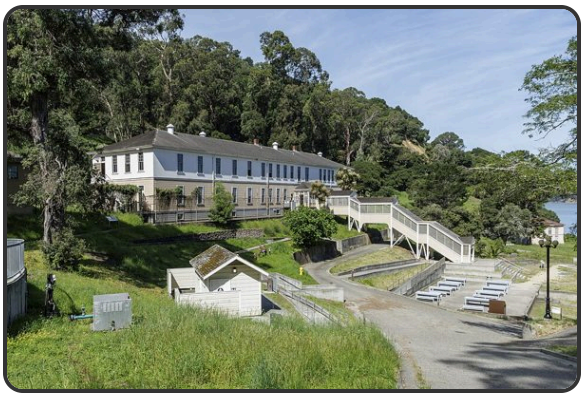
6. How did Progressives like Jacob Riis make life better for immigrants in cities?

🗽 Immigration & Cities: Reading

US History · Unit 3 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · our own reading

Name: _____

Words to know: ***detain*** *= to hold someone and not let them leave ·* ***interrogation*** *= a long set of questions*



Detention barracks, Angel Island Immigration Station

Angel Island: The Immigration Station in the West

Angel Island sits in San Francisco Bay, California. From 1910 to 1940 it was an **immigration station**, a place where newcomers were checked before entering the U.S. It is sometimes called the “Ellis Island of the West,” but it was very different.

Most detainees were Chinese, though people also arrived from Japan, Korea, India, Russia and Mexico. The **Chinese Exclusion Act** (1882) was the first U.S. law to ban immigration by one nationality. It blocked Chinese laborers; only merchants, students, diplomats, teachers and children of U.S. citizens could legally enter.

In 1906 an earthquake and fire in San Francisco destroyed many birth records. Some Chinese immigrants then came with papers saying they were the children of citizens. They were called **“paper sons”** and **“paper daughters.”**

Officials expected fraud, so they used **interrogations** that could last hours or days. Questions covered tiny details of home villages: how many houses were in a row, which way the house faced, who lived next door. A relative already in the U.S. answered the same questions; any mismatch could mean **deportation**.

At Ellis Island most European immigrants were processed in a few hours. At Angel Island, Chinese immigrants were often **detained** for weeks or months, and some for close to two years, in crowded, locked barracks with little privacy.

Some detainees carved **poems** in Chinese into the wooden walls. More than 200 poems survive. They tell about missing family, anger at unfair treatment, and hope for a new life.

A fire destroyed the administration building in 1940. During World War II, when China was a U.S. ally, Congress repealed the Exclusion Act (1943). Today the station is a National Historic Landmark and state park; the wall poems are preserved as a record of the immigrant experience.

Check your reading

1. Why were Chinese immigrants treated differently from European immigrants at Ellis Island?

2. Explain how the 1906 earthquake led to “paper sons” and to the long interrogations.

3. What do you think was hardest for detainees? Use a detail from the reading.

4. Why is it important that the wall poems were saved?

🗽 Immigration & Cities: Reading

US History · Unit 3 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with push/pull notes, Ellis Island, Voices of Angel Island, How the Other Half Lives

Name: _____

Coming to America, 1880-1920

Between 1880 and 1920 about 20 million immigrants came to the United States. People were pushed out of their home countries by war, hunger, poverty and persecution. They were pulled to America by factory and railroad jobs, cheap land and the promise of freedom. Most came from Europe, at first from northern and western countries such as Ireland and Germany and later from southern and eastern countries such as Italy, Poland and Russia.

Most European immigrants arrived in New York Harbor. They passed the Statue of Liberty, dedicated in 1886, with Emma Lazarus's poem welcoming “your tired, your poor, your huddled masses yearning to breathe free.” At Ellis Island, doctors gave quick medical exams and checked eyes for trachoma, and inspectors checked legal papers. About 2 percent were sent back.

On the West Coast the story was different. The Chinese Exclusion Act of 1882 was the first US law to ban immigration by one ethnic group. At Angel Island in San Francisco Bay, opened in 1910, Chinese immigrants were held for weeks or even months and questioned closely. Some carved poems about their sadness and anger into the walls.

Most new immigrants settled in cities, where the jobs were. In New York's Lower East Side, families crowded into tenements: narrow buildings with dark rooms, little air and shared toilets. Disease and fire were constant dangers. Reporter Jacob Riis photographed these conditions in his 1890 book “How the Other Half Lives,” which pushed New York to pass housing laws.

Immigrants built railroads, worked in factories and opened shops and newspapers. Many Americans welcomed them, but others feared job competition and different religions and languages. Cartoons of the time often drew immigrants with cruel stereotypes. People argued about whether America should be a “melting pot” where cultures blend, or a place where each group keeps its own traditions.

Check your reading

1. Give two push factors and two pull factors.

2. How was Angel Island different from Ellis Island?

3. Why did Jacob Riis take photographs of tenements?

🗽 Immigration & Cities: Quick Check

US History · Unit 3 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with push/pull notes, Ellis Island, Voices of Angel Island, How the Other Half Lives

Name: _____

Multiple choice and short answer. You may have it read aloud.

1. Which is a pull factor?

A. Crop failure at home | B. Religious persecution | C. Factory jobs in the US

2. The Chinese Exclusion Act (1882)…

A. Banned most Chinese workers from immigrating | B. Gave Chinese immigrants free land | C. Opened Ellis Island

3. Jacob Riis is known for…

A. Building the railroad | B. Writing The New Colossus | C. Photographing tenement life

4. Most immigrants after 1890 came from…

A. Southern and eastern Europe | B. South America | C. Australia

5. Why were Chinese immigrants treated differently from European immigrants?

6. What does the poem on the Statue of Liberty say about America's view of immigrants?

🗽 Immigration & Cities: Guided Notes · ANSWER KEY

US History · Unit 3 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with push/pull notes, Ellis Island, Voices of Angel Island, How the Other Half Lives

Name: _____

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immigrant | *push factor* | *pull factor* | *Ellis Island* | *Angel Island* | *Chinese Exclusion Act* | *tenement* | *Jacob Riis* | *melting pot* | *nativism*

A. Why they came (push/pull notes)

1. Fill in the table.

	Examples
Push factors	**war, hunger, poverty, persecution**
Pull factors	**jobs, land, freedom, family**

2. Fear of or dislike for immigrants is called **nativism**.

B. Arrival (Ellis Island and Angel Island)

3. Fill in the table.

	Ellis Island	Angel Island
Where?	**New York Harbor**	**San Francisco Bay**
Mostly from?	**Europe**	**China and Asia**
What happened?	**Quick medical and legal checks; 2% sent back**	**Held for weeks or months; questioned; Exclusion Act**

4. What hardships did Fong See and the Angel Island immigrants face?
Long detention, harsh questioning, separation from family, unfair laws.

C. Cities (How the Other Half Lives)

5. Describe tenement conditions. Give three details.
Crowded rooms, little light or air, shared toilets, fire danger, disease.

6. How did Progressives like Jacob Riis make life better for immigrants in cities?
Exposed conditions with photos; led to housing laws and reforms.

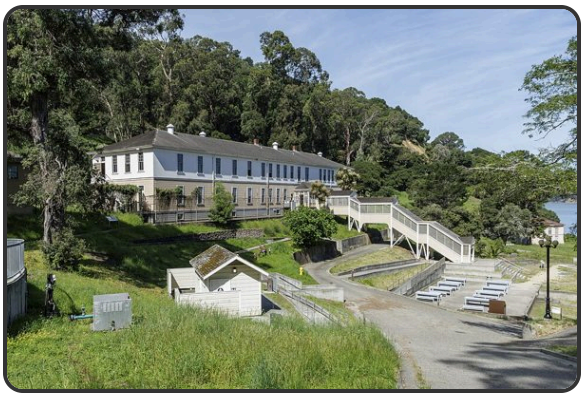
🔑 *Key written by our team from Ms. Stockmar's worksheets and slides, please check.*

🗽 Immigration & Cities: Reading · ANSWER KEY

US History · Unit 3 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · our own reading

Name: _____

Words to know: ***detain*** *= to hold someone and not let them leave ·* ***interrogation*** *= a long set of questions*



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Most detainees were Chinese, though people also arrived from Japan, Korea, India, Russia and Mexico. The **Chinese Exclusion Act** (1882) was the first U.S. law to ban immigration by one nationality. It blocked Chinese laborers; only merchants, students, diplomats, teachers and children of U.S. citizens could legally enter.

In 1906 an earthquake and fire in San Francisco destroyed many birth records. Some Chinese immigrants then came with papers saying they were the children of citizens. They were called **“paper sons”** and **“paper daughters.”**

Officials expected fraud, so they used **interrogations** that could last hours or days. Questions covered tiny details of home villages: how many houses were in a row, which way the house faced, who lived next door. A relative already in the U.S. answered the same questions; any mismatch could mean **deportation**.

At Ellis Island most European immigrants were processed in a few hours. At Angel Island, Chinese immigrants were often **detained** for weeks or months, and some for close to two years, in crowded, locked barracks with little privacy.

Some detainees carved **poems** in Chinese into the wooden walls. More than 200 poems survive. They tell about missing family, anger at unfair treatment, and hope for a new life.

A fire destroyed the administration building in 1940. During World War II, when China was a U.S. ally, Congress repealed the Exclusion Act (1943). Today the station is a National Historic Landmark and state park; the wall poems are preserved as a record of the immigrant experience.

Check your reading

1. Why were Chinese immigrants treated differently from European immigrants at Ellis Island?
The Chinese Exclusion Act targeted them; officials assumed fraud, so they were detained and interrogated for long periods.

2. Explain how the 1906 earthquake led to “paper sons” and to the long interrogations.
Records burned, so people could claim citizen fathers; officials used detailed questions to test those claims.

3. What do you think was hardest for detainees? Use a detail from the reading.
Answers vary: long waits, being locked up, fear of deportation, separation from family.

4. Why is it important that the wall poems were saved?
They are primary sources in the immigrants' own words about what they lived through.

🔑 *Key written by our team, please check.*

🗽 Immigration & Cities: Quick Check · ANSWER KEY

US History · Unit 3 · Level 3 (closer to the class work) · goes with push/pull notes, Ellis Island, Voices of Angel Island, How the Other Half Lives

Name: _____

Multiple choice and short answer. You may have it read aloud.

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B. Religious persecution

C. Factory jobs in the US

2. The Chinese Exclusion Act (1882)…

A. Banned most Chinese workers from immigrating

B. Gave Chinese immigrants free land

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3. Jacob Riis is known for…

A. Building the railroad

B. Writing The New Colossus

C. Photographing tenement life

4. Most immigrants after 1890 came from…

A. Southern and eastern Europe

B. South America

C. Australia

5. Why were Chinese immigrants treated differently from European immigrants?

Exclusion laws and racism targeted them, so they were detained and questioned.

6. What does the poem on the Statue of Liberty say about America's view of immigrants?

It welcomes the poor and those seeking freedom.

🔑 *Written by our team from her immigration calendar, warm-ups and exit tickets, please check.*